Using the CMS — a short course in five missions

Before you start (30 seconds)

Nothing here can break the site. Every save is versioned and reversible — get lost, close the tab, lose nothing.

Save is not Publish. If your change doesn't appear on the site, you saved a draft. That is the single most common confusion, and the whole of section five.

Do the missions in order. Each is short and ends with something you can see.

Mission 1 — Find your way around · 2 minutes

1. Go to **cms.magnifica.catholic.work/admin**
2. Look at the **left sidebar**. Six collections live there.
3. Click **Documents**.
4. Click **Magnifica Humanitas**.
5. Scroll the form. Change nothing.
6. Close the tab, or press back. **Do not press Save.**

Done when: you have seen the form and walked away without saving.

> Lost? The sidebar is always there. If it's hidden, reopen it from the icon at top left.

Mission 2 — See the Spanish · 2 minutes

1. Sign in and find the **locale switch** in the top bar — it reads **EN** or **ES**.
2. Switch it to **ES**.
3. Sidebar → **Doc paragraphs**.
4. Open any paragraph.
5. Look at two fields: **extract** (the quoted sentence) and **note** (our commentary).

Done when: you are reading Spanish in both fields.

> The Spanish here is finished — all nine paragraphs have both. The essays do not.

Mission 3 — Change something and watch it appear · 5 minutes

This mission teaches you the entire tool. It is worth the five minutes.

1. Sidebar → **Posts**.
2. Open **Introduction to Magnifica humanitas**.
3. Find the **abstract** field.

4. Add the word **TEST** at the end of it.
5. Press **Publish**. Not Save — **Publish**.
6. Wait two minutes.
7. Open **magnifica.catholic.work** and look at the essay.

Done when: you can see TEST on the live site.

> Nothing after three minutes? You pressed Save. Check the status reads **Published**.

Mission 4 — Undo it · 1 minute

1. Back in the CMS, delete the word **TEST**.
2. Press **Publish**.
3. Wait two minutes and refresh the site.

Done when: TEST is gone.

This is the real lesson. You just changed the live internet and put it back.

Mission 5 — Add a source · 3 minutes

1. Sidebar → **Sources** → **Create New**.
2. Fill in: **kind**, **authors**, **title**, **year**, **url**.
3. Set **verified_on** to today's date. It means *you checked the link works*.
4. Press **Publish**.

Done when: it appears in the Sources list.

The three statuses — the genuinely confusing part

Every document is in one of three states, shown next to its title:

- **Draft** — never published. Nothing on the site at all.
- **Published** — live. This is what people see.
- **Changed** — live, **but you have newer edits the world cannot see yet.**

If something looks out of date, you are in Changed. Press Publish.

Rescue card

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
My edit isn't on the site	You Saved instead of Published, or the status is **Changed**
I can't see the Spanish	The locale switch in the top bar is still on **EN**
I can't find a collection	The sidebar is collapsed — reopen it from the icon at top left
I'm overwhelmed	Close the tab. Nothing is lost.

You cannot break this. Every version is kept, and nothing here cannot be undone.